Inbound Lead Rubric

Every samples request gets one level, 0 to 3, about two seconds after the lead submits. Hard rules decide the clear cases; Claude scores the rest against this rubric and writes a one-line reason that shows in Slack and on the Salesforce Task. Shares are from a retrospective on 200 past inbounds.

LEVEL 0 · ~12% OF INBOUNDS
Dead end
Thank-you page. Salesforce Contact, not ready to call. No Task, no Slack.

LEVEL 1 · ~55%
Long shot
Thank-you page + "loop in your principal". Contact owned by the state BDR. No Task, no Slack.

LEVEL 2 · ~17%
Discovery
BDR's calendar on the page. High-priority Task to the BDR, Slack alert to the team.

LEVEL 3 · ~7%
First Touch
Growth manager's calendar on the page. Task to the GM, Slack alert with who to add to the call.

L0 Dead end

Anyone who will never buy a district curriculum.

- Parents and homeschoolers; students, or anyone whose message gives them away as one
- Vendors, sponsorship pitches and conference invites
- Press, politicians, universities and job seekers
- High-school-only teachers (no K-8 grades)
- Anyone outside the United States and Canada; internal tests and nonsense

Why: none of the ~25 in the sample produced a meeting, and each Slack post costs a BDR a read.

L1 Long shot

A real K-8 educator with no buying power and no stated reason to switch now.

- Teachers and interventionists whose message shows no evaluation, review or pilot
- ...at a district that isn't Hot or Warm in Starbridge
- Unknown or "Other" roles with nothing to place them

A teacher's adoption-year answer alone doesn't lift them. Coaches and TOSAs never land here.

Why: 0 of 5 meetings held with teachers who gave no evaluation signal advanced. A teacher's adoption answer isn't reliable on its own.

L2 Discovery with the BDR

A real chance, but we don't yet have the decision maker or the why-now, so a BDR goes and gets them.

- Champions without an active review: math/STEM director or coordinator, curriculum coordinator, MTSS coordinator, Title I director, SpEd director, assistant principal
- Decision makers with no why-now at a district that isn't Hot or Warm
- Principals outside NYC who lead one building of a larger district
- Instructional coaches, math coaches and TOSAs, always, even with no signal
- Teachers who write that their school is evaluating, previewing, piloting or reviewing, or whose district is Hot or Warm
- Any Level 3 that falls under the floor (below)

The call has two goals: the decision maker's name and the why-now. With both, the BDR books a First Touch.

Why: champions brought in our largest inbound deals (Burlington $200k, Oak Park 97, CESA 4). Teachers and coaches who booked qualified meetings (Kingman, Hainesport) all said they were evaluating.

L3 First Touch with the growth manager

The person who signs, or the person running the review, with a reason to change now.

- Decision makers (superintendent, assistant superintendent, CAO, curriculum director, director of teaching & learning, district administrator) with any why-now: adopting SY26-27 or SY27-28; a Hot or Warm district or a score of 70+; "I'm not sure" at a Strong or Ideal fit district; a message about searching, reviewing, piloting or pricing
- Champions running an active review ("we're starting a 6-8 review")
- Coaches and TOSAs at a Hot or Warm district
- Anyone whose message says they sit on the curriculum, adoption or pilot committee, or lead the review
- Principals who decide for their whole school: NYC, single-school districts, charters, privates

If no meeting is booked within 48 hours, the growth manager follows up personally.

Why: about 15 leads fit this profile in the sample and only 2 booked (Simsbury, Nenana). The rest waited 1–3 weeks in the BDR queue.

Before any level: customers and open deals

Existing customers and open US deals, on the school or its parent district, go straight to the deal owner, then the account owner. No calendar. Live once RevOps gives the app a Salesforce integration user.

Fast lane, no AI

Anyone who isn't a teacher, at a Hot Starbridge district with 5,000+ students, adopting SY26-27 or SY27-28, is Level 3 straight away.

Level 3 floor

A district with a Starbridge score under 50, or under 1,000 students, never gets a First Touch. Those leads become Level 2 with the BDR, whoever asks. No Starbridge data, no floor.

SIGNAL	EFFECT
The message says evaluating, previewing, reviewing, searching, piloting, or asks for pricing	Why-now. Teacher or coach → Level 2; decision maker or champion → Level 3. The message is the strongest signal and can override the role either way.
The message shows a student, parent, vendor or nonsense	Level 0, whatever role was picked
Adoption answer SY26-27 or SY27-28	Counts only from decision makers and champions
Coach or TOSA at a Hot or Warm district	Level 3
Starbridge Blocked, or the district just committed to another core program	Down one level

Tie-breakers

- Decision maker, champion or coach torn between 2 and 3 → 3.
- Teacher torn between 1 and 2 → 1, unless there's an evaluation signal or a hot district.
- Teachers reach Level 3 only through committee membership or leading the review.
- Every decision carries a one-line reason, under 25 words, naming the deciding factor.

HOW WE'LL KNOW IT WORKS	TARGET
Level 3 leads with a meeting booked within 7 days	Most; baseline 2 of ~15
Level 2 leads with a first BDR touch within 2 business days	All
Inbounds sent to a BDR on a district with a live deal	0; baseline ~7%

Sources: RUBRIC.md, prompts/rubric.md (what Claude reads), lib/rules.ts and lib/config.ts in the inbound-flow repo.

Routing diagram: Samples Inbound Routing